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Dear Hiring Manager,

Russell Cooke's Dispute Resolution Group is the kind of role I have been working toward. My year at BCLP gave me direct experience supporting contentious matters across international arbitration and real estate disputes, and my current work at Citizens Advice involves managing cases from instruction through to submission for clients with often competing and urgent needs. I think both translate well to a busy dispute resolution team handling a broad range of commercial and private client matters.

At BCLP's international arbitration team, I supported a complex investment arbitration through its procedural stages, reviewing and organising evidence, amending sections of the Claimant's memorial, drafting procedural orders and maintaining the case file structure. When I became the only junior on the matter shortly before a significant deadline, I took responsibility for coordinating documents and tracking outstanding actions across the team to ensure we submitted on time. That experience showed me what it actually takes to keep a contentious matter moving under pressure, and it is that kind of hands-on case support work I want to continue developing in a dedicated paralegal role.

The real estate disputes rotation added a different dimension. I helped prepare electronic hearing bundles, assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials, and managed large volumes of documents across several matters running simultaneously. That required careful attention to detail and consistent organisation, and the volume meant I had to make quick, reliable decisions about prioritisation. At Citizens Advice I now do something similar every day: I conduct client interviews, identify the relevant legal and evidential issues, draft correspondence, prepare document schedules and maintain confidential case records, often for clients in vulnerable situations where accuracy and clarity genuinely matter.

Russell Cooke's mix of commercial, charity and private client work is part of what draws me to this role specifically. My BCLP experience was almost entirely commercial, while Citizens Advice has given me a different perspective on how legal issues affect individual clients and how to communicate clearly across that divide. The combination of those two contexts has developed my understanding of how to adapt legal analysis and communication to what a client actually needs, which feels directly relevant to the work your Dispute Resolution Group does.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva